

Sergey Chekriy

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Remote / Global

Client testimonials: https://youtu.be/_jLgw_bmj-Q

Free BPMN course: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u6KAOHaTWqE>

CTO / Solution Architect | FinTech | Web3 | Systems Design

Profile

CTO / Solution Architect with 25+ years of engineering experience and deep expertise in fintech, Web3, and complex system design.

Focused on building the right architecture from day one: connecting technical decisions with business goals, financial model, project constraints, total cost of ownership, and long-term scalability.

Combines hands-on engineering expertise with strong systems thinking: systems must be not only technically correct, but also economically viable, maintainable, and understandable for future development.

Not a generic manager — leads through expertise, architecture ownership, deep domain understanding, and the ability to translate business goals into working technical solutions.

Core Expertise

- System architecture: from MVP to scalable enterprise platforms.
- Translation of business requirements into architectural, system, and technical solutions.
- Design of reliable solutions for different load profiles, including high-load and mission-critical systems.
- Backend, Web3, fintech, banking, SaaS, trading, DeFi, and hybrid on-chain/off-chain architecture.
- Financial modeling and system economics: tokenomics, pricing, cost structure, unit economics.
- Development planning, roadmap, milestones, budget and timeline control.
- Engineering team structuring based on architecture, required expertise, and system needs.
- Integration architecture, APIs, event-driven approaches, data flows, and system boundaries.
- Business process design, BPM/BPMN, process automation, and BPM-based platforms.

Architecture and Professional Skills

- Business requirements analysis and translation into architectural, system, and technical solutions.
- Interaction with business stakeholders, product owners, internal customers, founders, investors, and top management to clarify requirements and align solutions.
- Design of reliable architecture for different workloads: MVP, enterprise, banking, fintech, blockchain/Web3, trading, DeFi, SaaS, and high-load backend systems.
- Resolution of architectural challenges across applications, integrations, data, infrastructure, security, operations, and total cost of ownership.
- Supervision of development teams from the system architecture perspective for new systems and major changes in existing systems.
- Application of global architecture best practices and modern modeling tools: UML, ArchiMate, C4, BPMN, and other notations.
- Maintenance and development of a single architecture documentation repository: architecture decisions, integration diagrams, data models, business process diagrams, system contexts, and deployment views.
- Design of integrations between systems on different platforms: enterprise systems, banking systems, web/mobile applications, blockchain/Web3 components, external services, and legacy systems.
- Analysis of different architectural approaches with reasoned comparison of benefits, drawbacks, risks, cost of ownership, scalability, reliability, and business impact.
- Participation in the design of Kubernetes-based microservice systems, as well as systems using ML models, Big Data, artificial intelligence, and cloud technologies.

- Technology decision-making, work with modern tools, and participation in large-scale digital transformation projects.
- Participation in banking architecture strategy and development of corporate IT architecture.
- Increasing the maturity of architecture practice: architecture principles, standards, governance processes, documentation quality, architecture review, and work with development teams.
- Design of integration interactions, including REST/API, asynchronous integrations, message brokers, and event-driven architecture.
- Understanding of different database types and application criteria: relational, document, key-value, analytical stores, data warehouses, data-centric architecture, and BI approaches.
- Understanding of message brokers and queues: ActiveMQ, RabbitMQ, Kafka, and similar solutions.
- Understanding of information security methods: encryption, digital signatures, protected channels, access control, integration security, and system-level protection.
- Practical application of system architecture principles, design patterns, integration patterns, enterprise architecture, and system design.
- Ability to justify architectural and technology choices at different levels: business, architecture, development, operations, security, and total cost of ownership.
- Knowledge and experience with artificial intelligence systems, machine learning, and AI-assisted development.
- Banking industry experience and understanding of banking systems: core banking, BPM, digital banking, product-centric systems, integrations, risks, and regulatory constraints.
- Experience designing high-load systems, integration platforms, enterprise applications, and systems with strict reliability requirements.
- Ability to work in a team and build communication between business, development, analysts, infrastructure, security, vendors, and management.

Key Technologies and Domains

TOGAF, data-centric architecture, microservices, BPM, BPMN, UML, ArchiMate, C4, machine learning, AI, Big Data, Kubernetes, cloud technologies, blockchain, Ethereum, Solidity, Web3, DeFi, tokenomics, Java, JavaScript, Node.js, Python, REST, AWS, PMP.

Work Experience

Consulting

12/2017 — Present

CTO / Architect / Blockchain Developer for external clients. Main focus:

- Designed architectures for fintech, Web3, and SaaS platforms.
- Translated business requirements into scalable technical solutions.
- Defined system boundaries, services, and data flows.
- Designed tokenomics and financial logic for Web3 platforms.
- Planned development roadmaps with realistic timelines and budgets.
- Helped startup teams move from idea to MVP and production.
- Designed architectures for trading platforms, DeFi systems, backend services, and hybrid on-chain/off-chain systems.
- Defined integration strategy across multiple systems.
- Worked directly with founders and stakeholders.
- Structured development process, milestones, scope, cost, and delivery timelines.
- Built engineering teams based on required expertise.
- Prevented costly architectural mistakes at early stages.

Selected projects:

- Meme token development — ERC20.
- Cryptocurrency advisor — Ethereum.
- Helped Songsterr transition to a crypto economy.
- Crypto DeFi Ecosystem Consultant.
- Crypto Engineer.

- Smart contract expert for NFT minting.
- Smart contract audit.
- NFT/DAO Strategist & Consultant for African Talent Fund.
- Smart contracts and blockchain consultation.
- Staking contracts development.
- Contract audit.
- Crypto / asset tokenization consultant.
- Architect or Technical / Systems Analyst for a web app.
- Smart contract low-level amendments based on audit report.
- Solidity development for a new utility token smart contract on BSC.
- Solidity development for custom smart contracts.
- Mini-exchange development and frontend integration.
- Ethereum smart contracts for NFT art/character development.
- Blockchain technical consultation.
- Emerging tech, blockchain, crypto, whitepaper creation.
- Token development — blockchain developer for ERC20 token creation.
- Blockchain consulting.
- Part-time CTO.

Client Testimonials

Full client testimonials: https://youtu.be/_jLgw_bmj-Q

Glass Cube

12/2017 — 08/2019

CTO

Daily Activities

- Developed the architecture of I-CHAIN, an enterprise-grade Java-based blockchain platform.
- Managed an IT team of 20+ people.
- Communicated with investors and partners.

Project Activities

- Developed the core platform principles — whitepaper: https://github.com/sergey-chekriy/enterprise-blockchainplatform/blob/master/i-chain.net.wpaper_rev_005.pdf
- Developed the high-level platform architecture.
- Monitored ongoing IT development and provided expertise to the development team.

Accomplishments

- Enterprise blockchain platform: https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCVH3qc1m99bgB014fJLnOmA?view_as=subscriber
- Forbes publication: <https://www.forbes.com/sites/kenrapoza/2018/04/29/meet-the-russians-behind-your-blockchain-and-cryptocurrency-too/>

Societe Generale / Rosbank

11/2016 — 12/2017

Chief IT Architect

Daily Activities

- Developed corporate IT architecture.
- Communicated with internal business customers.

Project Activities

- Digital transformation program.

Accomplishments

- Digital transformation roadmap and project portfolio.
- Digital transformation outcomes, including:
 - core banking system upgrade;
 - rollout of product-centric systems;
 - rollout of BPM-based systems;
 - introduction of data-centric architecture;
 - other deliverables.

Promsvyazbank

09/2014 – 11/2016

Managing Expert

Daily Activities

- Business analysis and internal IT consulting for top management.

Project Activities

- Developed high-level architecture for IT solutions.
- Developed business process diagrams.
- Discussed and negotiated business requirements with business customers from SME and corporate business departments.
- Developed high-level IT requirements based on business requirements.
- Negotiated change requests with business customers.
- Monitored ongoing IT development and provided architecture expertise to development teams.
- Negotiated transition to support with IT support teams.

Accomplishments

- Internal BPM solutions: factoring and credit factory.
- Project for remote account opening for legal entities through external agents.
- Joint BPM-based platform enabling development of specific business applications on top of the platform.

British American Tobacco Russia

08/2013 – 09/2014

IT Account Manager Russia / BRM

Daily Activities

- Managed IT demand in Russia for the Commercial Business Unit: Marketing/Sales, Finance, HR, Legal and Corporate Affairs; negotiated business/IT strategy updates and new initiatives with business stakeholders and global IT colleagues.
- Managed business relationships and structured demand for IT projects and services.
- Managed IT budget, ensured accuracy and savings, and provided budget status updates to business/IT stakeholders.
- Communicated and negotiated with the Global IT Architecture team to ensure smooth local project implementation.
- Led a team of business analysts, a PM, and a financial analyst.

Project Activities

- Digital transformation program.
- Monitored the project portfolio, including the digital area, and provided regular portfolio status updates to business/IT stakeholders.
- Developed high-level architecture for IT solutions.
- Represented IT on project boards.
- Discussed and negotiated high-level business requirements with heads of functions, including Head of Marketing, HR, and others.

Accomplishments

- Digital transformation outcomes, including:
 - major Siebel CRM functionality update — rollout to approximately 2,000 trade representatives;
 - joint system for synchronizing outlets between BAT and exclusive distributor SNS — rollout to approximately 2,000 BAT sales reps and approximately 2,000 distributor sales reps;
 - mobile application for trade marketing / BTL — rollout to approximately 4,000 external marketing agents;
 - major SAP updates for Finance, HR, and other functions in the area of responsibility, including 1C integration.
- Due to anti-tobacco legislation in Russia, the position was cut because country-level IT Marketing positions no longer existed.

Digital Banking Startup

11/2010 — 04/2013

Ambitious banking project in Russia — a digital-centric Bank 2.0. Reported to the owners.

Head of Strategic Development & Projects

Daily Activities

- Managed relationships with owners and structured demand for IT projects and services.
- Managed the Project Office and Business Architecture teams — the “products factory”.
- Managed relationships with external IT providers and contractors.
- Managed budget, ensured accuracy and savings, and provided budget status updates to owners.

Project Activities

- Monitored and controlled project portfolio implementation.
- Developed high-level architecture for IT solutions.
- Discussed and negotiated high-level business requirements with owners.

Accomplishments

- Implemented the CFT-Bank core banking system in 4 months, including migration from the previous Inversiya system.
- Implemented internet banking and mobile banking, including online interaction with card processing and 1C integration for B2B internet banking.
- Implemented key retail and B2B products, including mortgage and structured products.
- Implemented key business processes.
- Built a high-performing team capable of launching new banking products and business processes; organized a professional project office.
- Financial project gain: \$200 million USD over 3 years.
- Exited the project due to the owners’ decision to fix profit and sell the business.

ImagineYou.ru

06/2007 — 11/2010

HR consulting / outstaffing / recruitment project.

Managing Partner / Business Development Director

Daily Activities

- Business development and meetings with prospective clients.
- Managed relationships with existing clients.
- Team management and development.
- Designed internal business processes and IT solutions.

Accomplishments

- Acquired key clients: British American Tobacco, Nestle, Eli Lilly, Astellas, Abbott, and others.
- Implemented key business processes and IT technology for the team.
- Created a professional team.
- Maximized profit.
- Sold the share to the partner after deciding to move to the banking project.

Unimilk

11/2006 — 06/2007

Second-largest milk producer in Russia at the time, now part of Danone.

Head of Strategic Development & Projects

Daily Activities

- Worked on the board of directors and provided status updates to the board and owners.
- Managed the Project Office team.
- Managed relationships with key stakeholders — the board.

Project Activities

- Monitored and controlled project portfolio implementation.

Accomplishments

- Organized the Project Office team with the key objective of making the company more efficient.
- Agreed and set up the company's strategic project portfolio, with key projects focused on launching national brands.
- Delivered cost savings by cutting non-strategic initiatives — approximately \$70 million USD.
- Implemented the key company project Biobalance, including installation of 8 PET lines, Biobalance brand development, trade channel development, and internal communication setup — internal portal and newspaper.
- Project Office results, including the launch of national brands Biobalance and Prostokvashino, became one of the key drivers of the successful Danone deal worth \$4 billion USD.
- Exited the project due to the owners' decision to use an external company for the project office, as required by creditors.

British American Tobacco Russia

12/2004 — 11/2006

IT Marketing Manager / BRM

Daily Activities

- Managed IT demand in Russia for Marketing and Sales functions; negotiated business/IT strategy updates and new initiatives with business stakeholders and global IT colleagues.
- Managed business relationships and structured demand for IT projects and services.
- Managed IT budget, ensured accuracy and savings, and provided budget status updates to business/IT stakeholders.
- Communicated and negotiated with the Global IT Architecture team to ensure smooth local project implementation.
- Led a team of business analysts.

Project Activities

- Monitored the project portfolio and provided regular portfolio status updates to business/IT stakeholders.
- Developed high-level architecture for IT solutions.
- Represented IT on project boards.
- Discussed and negotiated high-level business requirements with Head of Brands, Head of Trade, and Marketing Director.

Accomplishments

- Inventory and optimization of IT applications — reduced the number of automation applications from 300 to 20.
- Geo-expansion project — additional IT services coverage for 500 new sales locations, 50% growth.
- Implemented the IT stream in the Distribution Excellence project.
- Optimized Siebel CRM system for marketing needs.
- Implemented BI solution for marketing — Oracle BI.

IT Support and Administration Manager

12/2004 — 09/2005

Daily Activities

- Led the IT support team.
- Managed relationships with business stakeholders and structured demand for IT services.
- Managed IT budget, ensured accuracy and savings, and provided budget status updates to business/IT stakeholders.

Project Activities

- Managed the IT services improvement project.
- Designed new IT business processes and obtained sign-off from key business and IT stakeholders.
- Discussed and negotiated high-level SLA requirements with key business and IT stakeholders.
- Negotiated contracts with external providers.

Accomplishments

- Implemented the IT services improvement project: increased IT customer satisfaction from 60% to 80% in 6 months by changing IT processes and building a motivated team, including negotiations with outsourcer management, negotiations with key IT department heads and key customers, PR activities — IT brochure and IT communication boards, and running surveys.
- Designed and implemented the IT procurement process: developed and signed off SLA with the Procurement department.
- Negotiated and implemented Service Level Agreement: negotiations with key customers from functions — 24 customers, SLA design and sign-off.
- Implemented internal IT outsourcing project: migrated IT helpdesk from an in-source to an outsource model.

Eli Lilly

05/1998 — 11/2004

IT Department Manager

Daily Activities

- Managed IT Demand/Delivery in Russia, Ukraine, and Kazakhstan; negotiated business/IT strategy updates and new initiatives with business stakeholders and global IT colleagues.
- Monitored IT services performance and provided regular service performance status updates to business/global IT stakeholders.
- Managed business relationships and structured demand for IT projects and services.
- Managed IT budget, ensured accuracy and savings, and provided budget status updates to business/IT stakeholders.
- Communicated and negotiated with global IT teams to ensure smooth local project implementation.
- Led the IT team.

Project Activities

- Monitored the project portfolio and provided regular portfolio status updates to business/global IT stakeholders.
- Developed high-level architecture for IT solutions.
- Discussed and negotiated high-level business requirements with board members.
- Managed projects.

Accomplishments

- Implemented remote e-detailing: remote lectures by leading scientists for regional hospitals through videoconferencing and the internet. Benefit: fast and cost-effective rollout of a new Eli Lilly product; developed the business idea and managed this cross-functional Marketing-IT project.
- Implemented Cialis.ru brand website: managed the brand site implementation project.
- Implemented e-recruiting web system: developed the business idea and managed recruiting site implementation.
- Implemented regional-level European workflow automation solutions: worked as an expert for the Customer Service regional team.
- Implemented B2B system for sales office — distributors: developed the business idea and managed internet ordering site implementation.
- Implemented Sales and Marketing warehouse: worked as IT expert in the project.
- Rolled out SPP system: worked as IT expert in the project.
- Risk management project in CIS, including business continuity planning: worked as project manager for this business project.
- WAN, Remote Access, and VPN projects: managed VPN solution implementation across Russia for approximately 150 locations.
- Migrated from JDE to globally hosted SAP for Customer Service department.
- Migrated from SunSystems to Exact ERP for finance department.

Scala / Now Epicor

09/1996 — 05/1998

IT Department Manager

Daily Activities

- Led the IT team.
- Managed relationships with business stakeholders and structured demand for IT projects and services.
- Managed IT budget, ensured accuracy and savings, and provided budget status updates to business/IT stakeholders.
- Provided consulting to external clients — Scala installation and migration from Novell NetWare to Windows NT.

Project Activities

- Managed infrastructure-related projects.
- Implemented Six Sigma project in the IT area.
- Installed Scala at client premises.
- Migrated Scala from Novell NetWare to Windows NT.
- Resolved complex technical issues and performed custom setup.

Clients: Coca-Cola, Danone, Alfa-Laval, Tefal, BIC, Bosch, Ogilvy, and others, more than 100 clients; geography — Russia.

Accomplishments

- Successful office move — IT part.
- Successful IT services model implementation.
- VPN rollout for Scala consultants.
- Connected Scala offices — Moscow, St. Petersburg, Kyiv.
- More than 100 successful migrations of Scala clients from Novell NetWare to Windows NT across Russia.

MKT-Bank

1994 — 1996

Senior Programmer

Project Activities

- Developed distant banking solution — Lotus Notes.
- Developed internal automation solutions — Lotus Notes, C++.

Accomplishments

- Successfully developed and rolled out distant banking solution for business clients: software application patent №960304 “Client-Bank”, 1996.
- Successfully developed and implemented internal automation solutions.

Education

Durham University — Remote Education Programme

2007 — 2008

Certificate. Modules: Managing Systems, Managing People, Managing Finance, Managing in Global Environment, Managing in Competitive Environment.

Moscow Aviation Institute — State Technical University, Postgraduate Studies

Moscow, 1994 — 1998

Ph.D. in Computer Science.

Moscow Aviation Institute — State Technical University, Applied Mathematics

Moscow, 1988 — 1994

Engineer-mathematician.

Certifications and Awards

- Ph.D.
- PMP.
- AWS.

Patents — local, Russia

1. Software Application patent №960304 “Client-Bank”, 1996.
2. Software Application patent №2003610473 “Cash Application”, 2003.
3. Software Application patent №2003610228 “Contracts Database”, 2003.
4. Software Application patent №2003610325 “Customer Credit Files (CCF)”, 2003.
5. Software Application patent №2003610326 “Credit Distributors Committee (CDC)”, 2003.
6. Software Application patent №2003610327 “Medical Grant Committee (MGC)”, 2003.
7. Software Application patent №2003610328 “Travel Management System (TMS)”, 2003.
8. Software Application patent №2003610329 “Client Relationship Management (CRM)”, 2003.
9. Software Application patent №2003610330 “Auto Reports”, 2003.
10. Software Application patent №2010617537 “Breakout Robot”, 2010.
11. Software Application patent №2011611054 “Buydeep Robot”, 2011.
12. Software Application patent №2011611055 “Switching Robot”, 2011.

Trainings

- TOGAF 9.
- mini-MBA by IMD/INSEAD professors, organized by BAT.
- Leadership Trust: <http://www.leadership.org.uk/>
- Business Consultancy: <http://www.imd.org>
- Project Management courses — Project Management Institute, PRINCE2.
- Various IT courses — Microsoft MCSE and MCSA tracks, IBM/Lotus.
- PMP — Project Management Professional certification.
- Soft skills trainings: negotiations, management, presentation, leadership skills.
- ITIL, COBIT, BRM courses.
- Six Sigma — internal courses, Scala.
- Lean Six Sigma — internal courses, Eli Lilly.
- AWS.